

Market Concentration Case Studies

One-page portfolio brief

Project Overview

This Industrial Organization project analyzed market concentration in browser and credit-card issuer markets using CR4 and HHI. The project illustrates how concentration metrics can be used to compare industry structure and evaluate consolidation scenarios.

Case	Core calculation	Main insight
Browsers	HHI rises from 2,772 to 4,759; CR4 remains about 95-97%.	HHI reveals rising dominance within an already concentrated top group.
Credit-card issuers	Base HHI of 886; scenario HHI of 1,053; delta of +168.	Combining shares in a scenario shows how concentration changes after consolidation.

Market Concentration Case Studies

Industrial Organization analysis using CR4 and Herfindahl-Hirschman Index (HHI)

Core method

HHI = sum of squared firm market shares
Using percentage shares, HHI is often expressed on a 0-10,000 scale.
CR4 measures the combined share of the four largest firms.

Browser Industry

Firm-level HHI: 2,772 -> 4,759
CR4 remained high: 96.6% -> 95.0%

HHI rises because Chrome's share expands, even though the top-four share stays broadly high.

Credit-Card Issuers

Base HHI: 886
Hypothetical post-merger HHI: 1,053
Delta HHI: +168

The issuer case illustrates how merger scenarios can be evaluated by recomputing firm shares and HHI.

Portfolio signal:

Applied microeconomics • market-structure analysis • HHI calculation • competition-policy interpretation

Note:

These are course case studies and should be read as market-structure analysis rather than legal conclusions.

Selected undergraduate Industrial Organization project summary graphic.

Skills Demonstrated

- HHI and CR4 calculation
- Market-share data cleaning and organization
- Firm-level aggregation
- Scenario analysis
- Industrial Organization interpretation
- Professional summary communication